Lashkar's leaders are conscious of the fact that its students do not live in mosques or madaris and their goal is to prepare students to become productive members in society. Hence, as with the school at Muridke, all Al-Dawa schools taught subjects like mathematics and the hard sciences, with a particular emphasis on information technology.[25] This contributed to the group's technological prowess, which it used for military and missionary purposes, and also created a network of people within Pakistan's scientific community with ties to the organization. Despite secular aspects of the curriculum, Zafar Iqbal, who oversaw the education program, left little doubt that these schools had a missionary purpose when he said:

> Christians have set up high quality schools in order to wean Muslim children away from Islam. These schools teach Christianity even to Muslim children. Christians are thus successful in their mission. We are setting up Islamic institutions along the lines of Christian missionary schools.[26]

A fair proportion of the curriculum also focused on jihad. For example, an Urdu textbook used by the classes in their second year of primary education featured the final testaments of mujahideen given before they went into battle.[27] Secondary school primers were modified such that 'c' is for cat and 'g' is for goat became 'c' is for cannon and 'g' is for gun. Teachers also had to have taken part in at least one jihad campaign or gone for military training.[28] Schooling entailed a significant physical element, including swimming, mountaineering, wrestling and martial arts. This curriculum was intended to prepare students for jihad, even though the group never intended to send all of them to fight.[29] The aim was to promote Lashkar's interpretation of jihad as an activity which all Muslims are obligated to participate in or support. It also stemmed from the belief that, according to Hafiz Saeed, when Muslims 'gave up jihad, science and technology also went into the hands of others.' This was natural, he said, since 'the one who possesses power also commands science, the economy and politics.'[30]

The group also opened madaris through the Department of Construction of Masajid and Madaris in order to promote its interpretation of Ahl-e-Hadith Islam. In addition to the madrasa at Muridke, two other prominent ones were Jamia Abu Bakr and Jamaat-ul-Dirasat-ul-Islamiyah. Both are